BACKTRACK: judge review and revisions

What a judge should understand immediately

A student is stuck on today’s task and does not know which earlier skill to review. BACKTRACK uses the task and the answer to choose a useful starting check, connects that step to focused Khan practice, and checks the return with fresh problems.

The opening now explains both the problem and the response. Its headline is “Find the missing skill. Get back to today’s lesson.” An explicit problem statement sits above a labelled route: check today’s task, practice the missing skill with Khan Academy, then return with a fresh check. A judge can understand the proposal without opening the demo.

Slide 2 makes the navigation problem concrete. Searching quadratics is broader than checking whether the learner can find the required factor pair. Slide 3 explains the complete sequence. Slide 4 gives the creative mechanism a specific example: two wrong answers to the same equation can point to different first checks.

What the design review changed

The opening now states the problem and shows the response. A continuous blue route leads through the repair stop to a green destination pin, echoing the website's GPS route.

The two-answer comparison has one equation, matching answer cards, and a shared return step. Each card explains the clue and next check. Curved connectors show the shared outcome. Cards, text, and outcome remain native editable Canva elements.

The four-step slide uses consistent two-line labels. The closing headline is balanced across two lines. DM Sans regular and bold remain the presentation's only text family. Subtle street-map edges, blue navigation routes, green destination pins, and thin separators guide the reading order. BACKTRACK's custom green return-route monogram and the official UP Manila logo occupy a consistent header on every slide. The team confirmed institutional endorsement.

The route paths, original logo, and comparison connectors are scalable SVG graphics with their sources included. Text, cards, stops, and positions remain independently editable in Canva. The shared map-and-logo group can be ungrouped. The official university logo is preserved as artwork. The same Canva design and existing editor link are retained.

Why the demo adds something useful

The /demo page begins with one equation and two clickable wrong answers. Choosing 3 and 4 points to signs and solutions; choosing 2 and 6 points to factor pairs. The interface explains the clue, offers the matching repair, and uses fresh problems for the return. Replay makes the comparison easy to see.

This is the clearest creative feature: the same wrong score can lead to different help. The benefit is a better next decision at the moment a learner is stuck. Demonstrating a step can remove its review; learning a step changes what comes next. A saved route also gives the learner somewhere to resume after an interruption.

The learning stop contains one idea, a worked example, and local practice. The factoring example includes a verified 1:34 Khan video segment, with an option to continue. Other verified clips follow the same pattern. The learner can use the default reading-and-practice flow without leaving BACKTRACK. Extended Khan practice remains available.

The homepage now names each stop: check the factors, review if needed, then try the equation. Correct factor pairs shorten the illustrated route; incorrect or uncertain answers keep the review. Labels remain readable on mobile and sit away from the curve. The preview distinguishes a useful next step from having already solved the quadratic.

Slide 7 is entirely a demo invitation. Its button, visible link, and QR lead to the interactive sample. The short development note remains because it explains what the audience is trying. The website offers five destinations through the full learner flow, with readable route labels and a progress bar.

Assessment against the proposal's aims

The need is now readily apparent: having access to lessons does not automatically tell a learner which earlier step to work on. The proposal focuses on that navigation decision, a manageable repair, and the return to the lesson. Short study windows make this a useful design concern without requiring an invented attention-span statistic.

The mechanism is demonstrable and the Khan role is concrete. The school plan adds repeated, relevant Khan assignments and a clear question for evaluation: can the learner complete a fresh task after practice, and still do so 7-14 days later? The budget and destination kit explain how the routine could be maintained and repeated by another educator.

My judge assessment is that this is a credible first-round contender on clarity, mechanics, and potential. The strongest reason to pay attention is the visible difference between two learners' wrong turns and the useful next action each receives. The pitch should lead with that experience and its educational purpose. The comparison with teacher-selected Khan practice gives the proposed pilot a focused question to answer.